

URC2026 crystallised a strategic window: with €10B+ in recovery agreements signed and 160+ partnerships activated, Ukraine must now convert diaspora goodwill and IDP presence into structured workforce pipelines — or risk losing both cohorts permanently to host-country integration.

URC2026 crystallised a strategic window: with €10B+ in recovery agreements signed and 160+ partnerships activated, Ukraine must now convert diaspora goodwill and IDP presence into structured workforce pipelines — or risk losing both cohorts permanently to host-country integration.

RETURN

IOM & Ministry of Social Policy: Diaspora Engagement and Voluntary Return Framework

A dedicated session at URC2026 co-organised by IOM and Ukraine's Ministry of Social Policy addressed practical mechanisms for diaspora engagement and voluntary return facilitation, translating policy intent into actionable frameworks for reactivating Ukrainians abroad.

3R: Directly operationalises the Return pillar by establishing government-backed institutional pathways for diaspora reactivation — a critical signal of policy maturity heading into the recovery phase.

UKRAINE.IOM.INT

URC2026: 5.5 Million Returns Recorded, Regional Concentration in Kyiv and Kharkiv

IOM data presented at URC2026 confirms 5.5 million previously displaced Ukrainians have returned home, with the majority concentrating in Kyiv city and region, as well as Kharkiv and Odesa oblasts, reflecting both security perceptions and economic opportunity gradients.

3R: Provides a quantitative baseline for the Return pillar; the regional concentration pattern signals where workforce reintegration infrastructure must be prioritised.

FACEBOOK.COM / IOM POLAND

URC2026: €10 Billion in Agreements and Diaspora Mobilisation as Recovery Catalyst

URC2026 in Gdańsk produced over 160 agreements worth more than €10 billion, with Ukrainian diaspora organisations playing a visible role in recovery commitments, signalling that diaspora capital — both financial and human — is being formally integrated into reconstruction architecture.

3R: Elevates diaspora from a symbolic to a structural actor in recovery; creates entry points for human capital return alongside financial investment flows.

INSTAGRAM.COM

RECRUIT

ILO Local Employment Partnerships: Demand-Driven Skills Alignment for Labour Market Recovery

The ILO's Local Employment Partnership (LEP) model in Ukraine operates as a demand-driven mechanism connecting employer skill needs with skilling, upskilling, and reskilling programmes, directly addressing structural mismatches in Ukraine's war-affected labour market.

3R: Core Recruit mechanism: LEPs are the most scalable employer-linked skilling infrastructure currently operating in Ukraine — essential for filling critical workforce gaps across recovering sectors.

ILO.ORG

ILO LEP Article: Community-Level Job Creation and Skills Shortage Response

The ILO's narrative coverage of Local Employment Partnerships highlights how community-anchored partnerships are generating jobs and resolving skills shortages in Ukrainian regions, functioning as a decentralised recruitment and skills-matching infrastructure.

3R: Demonstrates the Recruit pillar in action at local level, with measurable employer-community linkages that can be replicated and scaled across oblasts.

ILO.ORG

VoxUkraine: Economic Impact of Integrating Inactive Women into the Workforce

A VoxUkraine study quantifies the economic uplift achievable by providing retraining and employment to currently unemployed Ukrainians and activating economically inactive women,

identifying this population as a significant untapped domestic labour reserve critical for recovery.

3R: Provides an evidence base for targeted Recruit strategies focused on domestic labour activation — particularly women — as a complement to diaspora return and external recruitment.

VOXUKRAINE.ORG

Razom for Ukraine: 1.5–2 Million Young Ukrainians Abroad — Youth Leadership at URC2026

Razom for Ukraine highlights that between 1.5 and 2 million young Ukrainians are currently living abroad, while mobilising 30 young leaders from the EU, Switzerland, and the US to participate in URC2026, framing youth engagement as a bridge between diaspora talent and domestic recovery needs.

3R: Quantifies the youth talent gap and demonstrates an active pipeline-building effort — critical for future-proofing Ukraine's skilled workforce through targeted youth recruitment and return pathways.

FACEBOOK.COM / RAZOM FOR UKRAINE

RETAIN

NRC / ReliefWeb: Ukraine's Recovery Risks Leaving Millions Behind — IDPs and Returnees in Crisis

The Norwegian Refugee Council warns that Ukraine's recovery trajectory risks marginalising 3.42 million IDPs and 4.2 million returnees as of May 2026, with inadequate housing, services, and livelihood support threatening to push vulnerable populations — including skilled workers — into secondary displacement or emigration.

3R: Critical Retain signal: failure to integrate returnees and IDPs into stable livelihoods will reverse Return gains and accelerate brain drain — making social protection and inclusive recovery prerequisites for human capital retention.

RELIEFWEB.INT / NRC

CEDOS: Third Places in Cultural Institutions as Community Anchors During Wartime

CEDOS is developing a guide for creating 'third places' — informal community spaces — within cultural institutions, based on wartime data collection on societal impacts. These spaces function as social retention infrastructure, fostering belonging and reducing the psychological push factors driving emigration.

3R: Addresses the soft infrastructure of Retain: community cohesion and sense of belonging are evidence-based predictors of willingness to remain — particularly among educated urban populations most at risk of brain drain.

CEDOS.ORG.UA

GLOBAL CONTEXT

Migration Policy Institute: Ukrainian Immigrant Population Growth in the United States Post-2022

MPI research by Jeanne Batalova documents the significant growth of the Ukrainian immigrant population in the United States following Russia's full-scale invasion in 2022, providing a demographic baseline for understanding the scale and profile of the US-based Ukrainian diaspora as a potential human capital reservoir.

3R: Establishes the US diaspora as a quantifiable Return and Recruit resource; understanding its composition is prerequisite for designing targeted re-engagement and talent pipeline programmes.

MIGRATIONPOLICY.ORG
